



Daffodil
International
University

ASSIGNMENT

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Short-Term Activity Report

Talking with Strangers

1. Introduction

As part of a short-term activity assigned by our teacher, I was asked to interact with three strangers and learn more about them through a short conversation. The main purpose of this activity was to step outside my usual social circle, communicate with unfamiliar people, and understand their experiences, backgrounds, and perspectives.

For the activity, I approached three individuals whom I did not previously know and asked them four questions regarding their name, hometown, reason for choosing their department, and one important lesson they learned during their admission journey. Although the conversations were brief, they provided several interesting insights into how different people make academic decisions and how their experiences shape their opinions.

2. Objectives of the Activity

The major objectives of this activity were:

- To develop confidence in communicating with unfamiliar people.
- To improve interpersonal and communication skills.
- To learn about the educational backgrounds and experiences of other students.
- To understand the different reasons people choose a particular academic department.
- To learn from the admission experiences of others.
- To become more comfortable initiating conversations with strangers.
- To understand that people can have very different perspectives despite being part of the same academic environment.

3. Motivation

The main motivation behind this activity was to encourage me to step outside my usual social circle and communicate with people I did not already know. In our daily university life, we usually interact with our friends, classmates, and familiar people, so approaching a stranger and starting a conversation can be challenging. This activity provided an opportunity to overcome that hesitation and develop greater confidence in social communication.

Another motivation was to learn about different people's experiences, backgrounds, and perspectives. By asking the three strangers about their hometowns, reasons for choosing their department, and admission experiences, I was able to understand that every student has a different journey. Their answers helped me see how personal interests, previous education, skills, and individual experiences can influence important academic decisions.

Overall, the activity motivated me to become more confident, open-minded, and willing to communicate with new people. It also showed me that even a short conversation with a stranger can provide valuable knowledge and a different perspective on life and education.

3. Methodology

I conducted short, informal interviews with three strangers. I asked each person the same four questions:

1. What is your name?
2. Where is your home?
3. What made you join this department?
4. What is one lesson you learned from your admission journey?

The responses were recorded and later organized for this report. The conversations were conducted in a friendly and informal manner so that the participants could comfortably share their experiences.

4. Interview Findings

4.1 Person 1: Angshu Rudra

Name: Angshu Rudra (Agricultural Science)

Hometown: Chittagong

Reason for Joining the Department

Angshu Rudra explained that he was attracted to the subjects offered by the department. The topics and academic subjects interested him, which influenced his decision to join the department.

His response shows that personal interest in academic subjects can play an important role in choosing a field of study. Instead of selecting a department solely because of external pressure or popularity, his decision was influenced by his attraction toward the subjects themselves.

Lesson from the Admission Journey

When asked about one lesson he learned from his admission journey, Angshu described the experience as "overhyped." This suggests that the admission process may sometimes appear more difficult, stressful, or significant than it actually turns out to be.

His experience highlights the importance of maintaining a realistic perspective during the admission process. Students may experience unnecessary anxiety because of the expectations and pressure surrounding university admission.



Image: With Angshu Rudra

4.2 Person 2: Aditto Ghos

Name: Aditto Ghos (Agricultural Science)

Hometown: Chittagong

Reason for Joining the Department

Aditto Ghos mentioned that he previously completed a Diploma in Agriculture and had a strong interest in agriculture. His previous educational background and personal interest influenced his decision to join the department.

His response demonstrates that academic choices are not always based on a single factor. Previous education, personal interests, and future academic goals can all influence a student's decision to enter a particular department.

Lesson from the Admission Journey

Aditto shared an interesting point about his admission journey: he did not have to sit for an admission test.

This experience was different from the conventional admission process that many students go through. It demonstrates that students can enter academic programs through different pathways depending on their educational background and institutional admission policies.

His experience also reminded me that every student's admission journey can be different, and it is not appropriate to assume that everyone follows the same process.

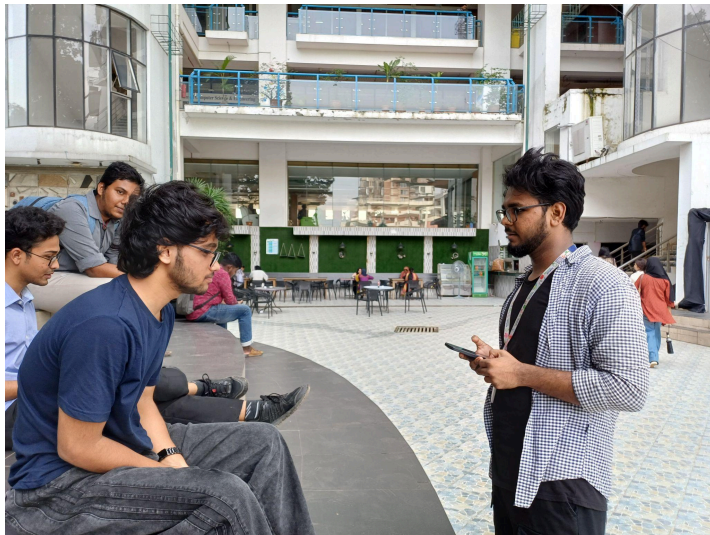


Image: With Aditto Ghos

4.3 Person 3: Megh

Name: Megh (Software Engineering)

Hometown: Lokkipur

Reason for Joining the Department

Megh explained that they had already been involved in coding before joining the department. Their previous experience with programming created an interest in continuing their education in this field.

This response shows the importance of prior exposure when choosing an academic discipline. Having practical experience with coding before entering the department helped Megh develop an understanding of the field and encouraged them to pursue it further.

Lesson from the Admission Journey

Megh shared the lesson that "public isn't everything."

This statement reflects the idea that getting admission to a public university or institution should not necessarily be considered the only measure of academic success. There can be valuable opportunities in different types of institutions, and students should consider factors such as their interests, goals, learning environment, and opportunities rather than focusing exclusively on institutional status.

This was one of the most meaningful perspectives I received during the activity because it challenged the common assumption that public institutions are automatically the best option for everyone.



Image: With Megh

6. My Achievement

This activity provided me with several important lessons.

First, I learned that starting a conversation with a stranger is not necessarily as difficult as it initially seems. Approaching someone unfamiliar requires a certain level of confidence, but once the conversation begins, people are often willing to share their experiences.

Second, I learned that everyone has a different story. Even though the three individuals are students within an academic environment, their educational backgrounds and reasons for choosing their department were completely different.

Third, the activity helped me understand that academic decisions should not be judged only from the outside. A person's choice of department may be influenced by personal interests, previous education, skills, experiences, or opportunities.

Finally, I learned the value of listening to other people's experiences. A short conversation can provide perspectives that we may not encounter through our usual friends or classmates.

7. Impact on my personal life

This activity had a positive impact on my personal life, especially on my confidence and communication skills. Talking to three strangers required me to overcome my initial hesitation and take the initiative to start a conversation. This helped me become more comfortable with approaching unfamiliar people and expressing myself clearly.

The activity also improved my listening skills. Instead of only focusing on asking questions, I had to pay attention to the answers and understand the experiences and opinions of each person. I realized that everyone has a different background and perspective, and listening to others can help me learn things that I may not experience myself.

Another important impact was that it made me more open-minded. The three people had different reasons for choosing their department and different experiences during their admission journey. Their responses taught me not to judge someone's choices based only on common assumptions or social expectations.

Overall, this activity helped me become more confident, socially comfortable, and open to meeting new people. I believe these skills will be useful not only in my academic life but also in my future professional and personal life.

8. Conclusion

The short-term activity of talking with three strangers was a meaningful learning experience. Through conversations with Angshu Rudra, Aditto Ghos, and Megh SWE, I learned about three different educational backgrounds, motivations, and admission experiences.

The activity helped me improve my confidence in communicating with unfamiliar people and taught me that everyone has a unique story and perspective. It also showed me that choosing a department and going through the admission process can be very different for different individuals.

Most importantly, I realized that meaningful learning can happen not only through classrooms and textbooks but also through simple conversations with people around us. This activity encouraged me to become more open to communicating with new people and learning from their experiences.